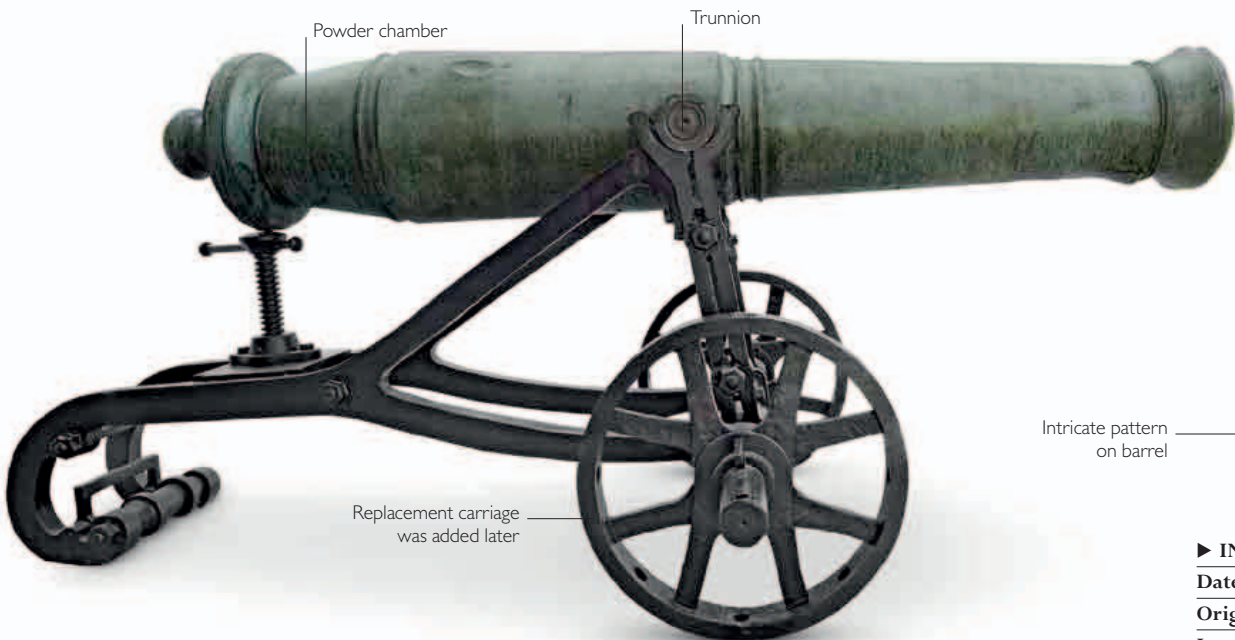




FIELD AND SIEGE ARTILLERY (1781–1830)

In the 17th century, many gunmakers in Europe decided to make muzzle-loading guns rather than breech-loaders, as improvements in gunpowder made it more difficult to build breech-loading guns that could withstand the pressure of firing. As a result, by the 18th century, almost all types of large-caliber artillery were muzzle-loading. Deployed on battlefields, field artillery fired solid shot, explosive shells, or canister shot (shot made of smaller balls). Siege artillery was employed for consistent bombardment of fortifications and fired larger types of shot and shell from prepared emplacements.



▲ **RUSSIAN LICORNE**
Date 1793
Origin Russia
Length 9ft (2.8m)
Caliber 8.07in (205mm)
Range 1,800 yards (1.6km)

This gun, which saw action in the Crimean War (1853–56), could fire horizontally or at an elevated trajectory. It carried gunpowder in a powder chamber shaped like a cone. It could shoot spherical explosive shells as well as cannonballs.



► **FRENCH 12-POUNDER FIELD GUN**
Date 1794
Origin France
Length 6¾ft (2.1m)
Caliber 4.8in (122mm)
Range 2,000 yards (1.8km)

This 12-pounder was named “Voltaire” after the French Enlightenment philosopher François-Marie Arouet de Voltaire (1694–1778), whose name is engraved into the forward part of the gun’s barrel. The barrel exhibits battle damage, possibly caused by British guns at the Battle of Waterloo (1815).



▲ **BRONZE ROYAL MORTAR**
Date 1800
Origin England
Length 1¼ft (0.39m)
Caliber 5.7in (144.8mm)
Range 800 yards (730m)

A standard mortar in British field service, this weapon was cast at the Woolwich Royal Brass Foundry. It fired a spherical, cast iron explosive shell at a high angle. Although transported by cart, it was placed on the ground during firing.



► **INDIAN BRONZE FIELD GUN**
Date 1800
Origin India
Length 6ft (1.8m)
Caliber 3.9in (99mm)
Range 1,600 yards (1.4km)

This finely decorated barrel was cast in the late 18th century and later fitted to its handsome carriage. It was captured by British forces from Maharaja Ranjit Singh of Punjab (a kingdom that spanned regions in modern-day India and Pakistan) during the first Anglo-Sikh War, which was fought in 1845–46.